POST-MATCH TACTICAL REPORT / LA LIGA 2026/27

EL CLASICO

SPACE UTILIZATION & WINNING FACTORS

25 October 2026 | Spotify Camp Nou | Prepared 27 October 2026

FC BARCELONA

1 HOME

REAL MADRID

2 AWAY

THE RESULT IN ONE SENTENCE

Barcelona controlled more of the ball and took more shots; Madrid created higher-value chances and struck decisively on a late transition.

POSSESSION	SHOTS	xG	SAVES
62% / 38%	18 / 10	1.19 / 1.95	3 / 5

CORE FINDING

The strongest evidence for the Madrid win is the combination of shot quality (about 1.95 xG from 10 shots versus 1.19 from 18), more saves by Lunin, defensive volume, and the 87th-minute Bellingham-Camavinga-Mbappe transition. Space maps in this report distinguish sourced match events from schematic illustrations.

Data basis: user-supplied post-match report, Opta Analyst, FC Barcelona, Reuters, FotMob, FBref and StatMuse. Full URLs in Sources.

01 | Match evidence at a glance

POSSESSION
62 / 38%
Barcelona held more of the ball.

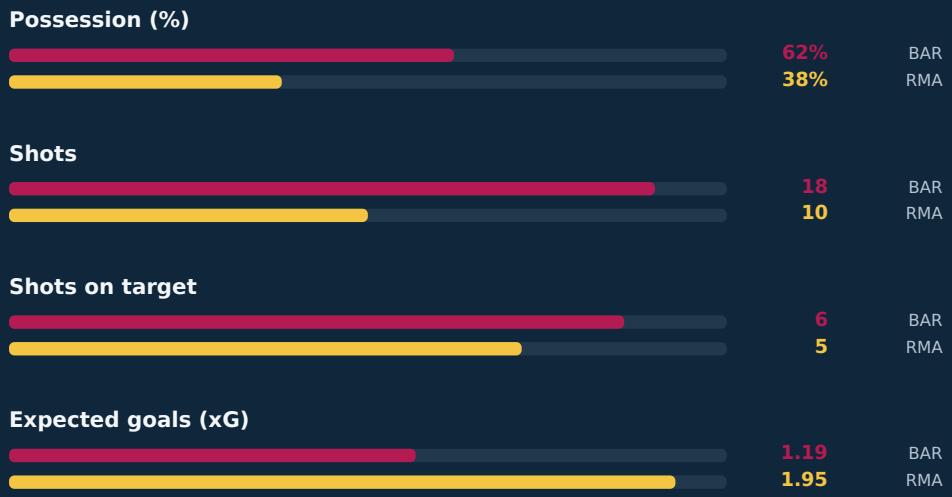
TOTAL SHOTS
18 / 10
Barcelona took eight more shots.

EXPECTED GOALS
1.19 / 1.95
FotMob display; other feeds vary slightly.

OPPOSITION-BOX TOUCHES
36 / 24
More territory for Barcelona.

SAVES
3 / 5
Lunin recorded five saves.

ATTACKING OUTPUT



Barca led in volume; Madrid led in aggregate xG. Bars compare Barcelona (pink) with Real Madrid (gold). [1][4][6]

WHAT THE NUMBERS MEAN

Chance value: xG per shot was approximately 0.066 for Barcelona (1.19 / 18) and 0.195 for Madrid (1.95 / 10). That is roughly three times higher per attempt for Madrid, based on FotMob values.

Conversion: Barcelona scored once from 18 attempts (5.6%); Madrid scored twice from 10 (20%). These are simple scoreline-to-shot ratios, not a stable measure of future finishing skill.

Defensive activity: match-stat feeds report 54 recoveries to Madrid and 46 to Barcelona, plus 14 interceptions to 7. This supports a more active ball-winning profile, but does not by itself prove superior defending. [5][6]

Interpretation: possession and shot count describe volume; xG, shot outcome and the timing of transitions better explain why this particular game ended 1-2.

02 | Why Real Madrid won

1. HIGHER CHANCE VALUE

Madrid produced about 1.95 xG from 10 attempts, versus Barcelona's 1.19 from 18. The difference was not shot volume; it was the quality and/or context of chances generated. [1][4]

xG / shot: 0.195 vs 0.066

2. TRANSITION THREAT

Reports describe Madrid escaping Barcelona's press with urgent, precise circulation, then attacking the space left behind. The 87th-minute winner finished a fast break involving Bellingham and Camavinga before Mbappe. [1][3]

Decisive chain: progression -> channel run -> cut-back

3. DEFENSIVE RESISTANCE

Madrid recorded more recoveries (54 vs 46), interceptions (14 vs 7) and clearances (31 vs 17) in the cited match-stat feeds. These totals fit a match in which Madrid had to defend without the ball. [5][6]

More defensive actions = workload, not automatically quality

4. GOALKEEPING & EXECUTION

FotMob lists five saves for Lunin and three for Barcelona's goalkeeper. The saved chances helped Madrid survive Barcelona's second-half push, while Mbappe converted the two goals that decided the score. [4][6]

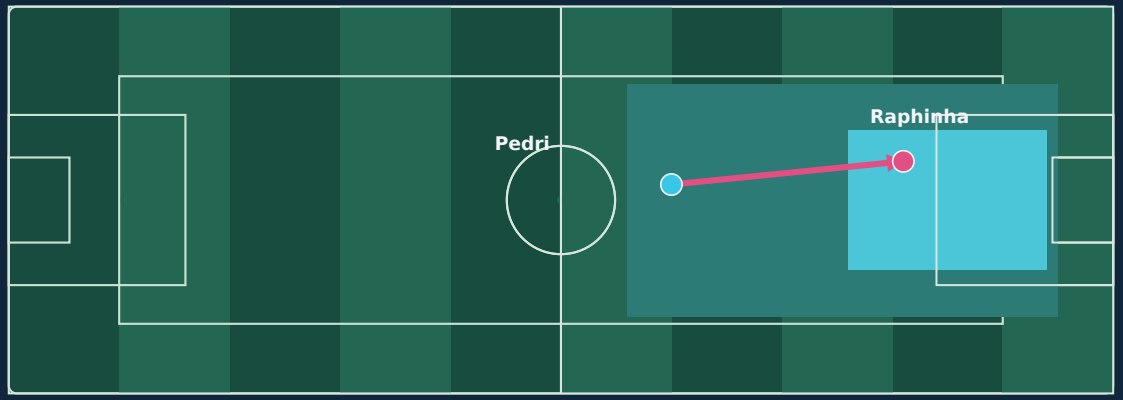
Saves: 5 vs 3 | Goals: 2 vs 1

TACTICAL CAUTION

The match supports the idea that Madrid were more effective in transitions and finishing. Without tracking data, exact space, line height, sprint distance and missed passing lanes cannot be measured.

03 | Barcelona - space used and space left open

BARCELONA: POSSESSION / FINAL-THIRD TERRITORY



ATTACKING DIRECTION: LEFT TO RIGHT

Tactical illustration from match reports; zone shapes are schematic, not event coordinates.

Space Barcelona used

- Sustained possession and territorial pressure, especially after the equaliser. - Pedri found Raphinha on the right side of the penalty area for the 61st-minute goal. - 36 touches in the opposition box and 18 shots show repeated access to attacking areas. [1][2][4]

WHAT WORKED

Volume and territory: 62% possession, 18 shots, six on target, and 36 opposition-box touches. Barcelona moved Madrid deeper after half-time and found the equaliser through Pedri and Raphinha. [2][4]

WHAT DID NOT TRANSLATE

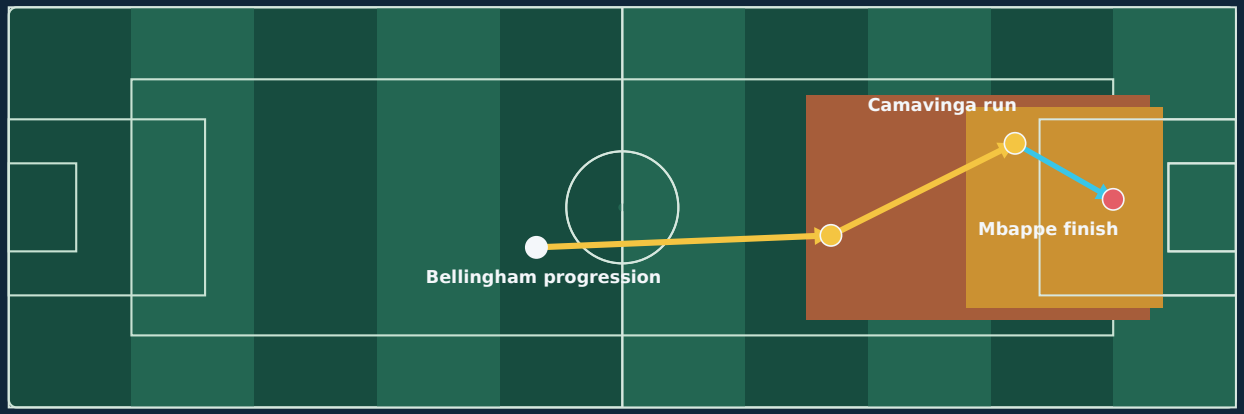
- Only one goal from 18 shots; six efforts were blocked in the supplied analysis. - Yamal had five shots worth 0.51 xG in Opta reporting but did not score. - Territorial dominance did not prevent Madrid from counterattacking into space behind the back line. [1][7]

SPACE LEFT VULNERABLE

The match narrative points to space behind Barcelona's defensive line during turnovers. It was exploited on breaks, including the decisive late sequence. This is qualitative, not a measured heat map. [1][3]

04 | Real Madrid - space exploited and winning sequence

REAL MADRID: TRANSITION ROUTE TO THE WINNER



ATTACKING DIRECTION: LEFT TO RIGHT

Narrative route schematic only; arrows are not measured player coordinates.

Reported sequence: Bellingham advanced the move, substitute Camavinga burst down the right channel and squared the ball for Mbappe to finish into an unguarded net in the 87th minute. [1][2]

Space Madrid exploited

- Behind Barcelona's line after turnovers.
- Camavinga's right-channel run.
- Mbappe's finish after the cut-back. [1][3]

WHY THE ROUTE WAS EFFECTIVE

Verticality: Madrid moved quickly from progression to penetration, reducing the time Barcelona had to recover their defensive shape.

Timing: the late run arrived as the ball carrier committed the defence, opening a finishing lane rather than requiring a low-probability shot from distance.

SPACE CONCEDED BY BARCELONA

The high territorial position that helps Barcelona sustain attacks can leave a large recovery distance after a turnover. Reports describe Madrid finding space in behind. Exact line height or gap in metres is unavailable. [1][3]

SPACE MADRID LEFT TO BARCELONA

Barcelona still reached the box and scored through Pedri-Raphinha after a quick corner sequence; Madrid had to defend sustained pressure after the equaliser. Madrid won despite, not because of, owning the ball. [2][3]

05 | Space used, conceded and missed - evidence matrix

TEAM / SPACE	USED	CONCEDED	MISSED / UNDER-USED	EVIDENCE LEVEL
Barcelona	Territory in the attacking half; right-side box access for Pedri to Raphinha.	Depth behind the high line during transitions.	Some possession/shots did not turn into high-value goals; Yamal 5 shots, 0 goals.	Aggregate + reported sequence
Real Madrid	Space behind Barcelona after turnovers; right-channel run for Camavinga and Mbappe finishing lane.	Sustained Barcelona pressure after 1-1; multiple box entries and 18 shots.	Earlier transition opportunities were not always completed or converted.	Reported match narrative + stats

SPACE USED

A zone or lane a team reached and used to progress, create or finish an attack.

SPACE CONCEDED

An area available to the opponent during build-up, transition or defensive recovery.

SPACE MISSED

A plausible open lane that was not exploited; requires video/event review to validate.

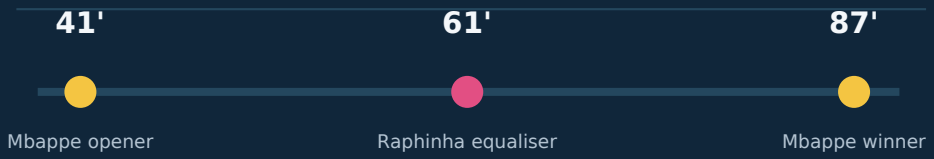
SPACE CONTROL

Possession, pressure or recovery dominance in an area; needs tracking/events for precision.

Important: “missed space” is an analyst interpretation, not a standard event statistic. A measured space-utilization map requires player tracking or reliable event coordinates.

06 | Key events and player influence

MATCH TIMELINE



The decisive moment was the late transition after Barcelona had levelled the match. The first Madrid goal was deflected off Gerard Martin; Camavinga assisted the second. Some feeds list the winner at 87' and others at 88'. [1][2][4]

INDIVIDUAL IMPACT

Mbappe (Madrid)

Two goals from three shots in Opta reporting; decisive target of the winning cut-back. [1]

Bellingham (Madrid)

Progressed the late winning attack and helped commit the defence before Camavinga's run. [1]

Camavinga (Madrid)

Entered at 80'; delivered the assist for the 87' winner. [1][4]

Raphinha + Pedri (Barca)

Pedri found Raphinha on the right side of the area for the equaliser. [1][2]

Yamal (Barca)

Five attempts with 0.51 xG but no goal, according to Opta. [1]

BARCELONA: THREAT WITHOUT ENOUGH GOALS

Barcelona's 18 shots and 36 opposition-box touches show that Madrid could not simply keep the hosts away from the box. However, the 1-goal return from 18 attempts and Yamal's 0.51 xG without a goal illustrate a difference between reaching dangerous areas and finishing the attack. [1][4]

The evidence points to a combination of shot outcomes, keeper saves and moments of blocked or poorly executed finishing - not to an absence of attacking territory.

REAL MADRID: DEFENDING AND COUNTERATTACKING

Reuters described Madrid as organised and composed enough to play out from Barcelona's pressure. Published reporting highlights Valverde's awareness of space after turnovers and the final sequence in which Bellingham and Camavinga advanced the ball quickly for Mbappe. [1][3]

The defensive stats (31 clearances, 14 interceptions, 54 recoveries) fit a team that spent more time without the ball but repeatedly disrupted attacks. They should be read alongside the five saves by Lunin, not treated as a standalone defensive-quality score. [5][6]

07 | Tactical map layers - what is known and what is not

SHOT MAP + xG

Shots, on-target count, team xG and selected player xG are reported. Exact shot start coordinates are not in the supplied workbook.

Partial aggregate data

PASSING NETWORK

Reports describe the key goal combinations. A full player-to-player network requires pass start/end coordinates and passer/receiver IDs.

Not measurable from aggregates

PRESSING HEAT MAP

Reports describe Barcelona pressure and Madrid playing through it. Pressure-event coordinates/intensity and PPDA event definitions are needed for a true map.

Qualitative only

BALL RECOVERY / LOSS

The supplied report gives match totals (recoveries and possession losses) but not the x/y location or player attribution for every event.

Team totals only

AVERAGE POSITIONS / FORMATION

Different sources report different formations. No single average formation is asserted without player tracking or consistent event coordinates.

Provider conflict

SPACE USED / MISSED

Documented attacks support qualitative tactical analysis, but exact space occupancy, uncovered lanes and missed-run counts need tracking/video coding.

Narrative illustration

REAL EVENT SOURCE TO CHECK

Opta Analyst published a sequence graphic for Mbappe's winning goal (86:44-86:54). It illustrates the final attack, but is not a substitute for full-match tracking data. Open the source graphic.

08 | Data quality, conflicts and safe interpretation

VALUES USED IN THE MAIN REPORT

Most consistently supported: score 1-2, possession 62%-38%, shots 18-10, shots on target 6-5, xG around 1.19-1.22 for Barcelona and 1.94-1.95 for Madrid, and the 41', 61', late 87'/88' goal sequence. [1][2][4][5][6]

For numerical comparisons, this report uses FotMob's 1.19 / 1.95 xG display and reports rounding/provider differences separately.

CONFLICTS NOT HIDDEN

Pass totals: the supplied PDF reports 726 vs 369 completed passes when summing pitch zones, while StatMuse displays 574/645 and 327/385. These may use different event scopes/definitions, so pass counts are not used as a decisive claim.

Formations: the supplied report notes 4-3-3 and 4-2-3-1 disagreement. The report therefore does not assert one exact average formation.

LIMITATIONS THAT MATTER FOR THE MAPS

- No verified event-coordinate CSV/JSON or tracking stream was provided with the uploaded reports.
- The dots, heat blobs, passing lines and player positions in generated dashboard images are conceptual placeholders, not measured match data.
- Possession losses/recoveries in team-total tables cannot be assigned to a pitch zone or player without event-level coordinates.
- “Space used”, “space conceded” and “space missed” in this report are labelled as reported sequence diagrams or tactical interpretations, not physical-space measurements.

Data rule for any future publication: use real event coordinates for shots and passes, event timestamps for pressure/recovery/loss locations, and tracking data for occupancy, line height, distances and unsampled space.

09 | Data needed for measured tactical maps

EVENT DATA REQUIRED

For each event, obtain a consistent provider feed containing at minimum:

- match_id, event_id, period, timestamp / minute
- team_id, player_id, event_type, possession_id
- x, y for event start; end_x, end_y where relevant
- outcome / success, body part, shot type, xG for shots
- passer and receiver IDs, pressure/counterpress flags if available
- provider coordinate specification and pitch orientation

TRACKING DATA REQUIRED FOR SPACE

Event data is not enough to calculate all space metrics. For robust space / formation work, obtain time-stamped player positions for both teams and the ball.

- Frame or timestamp + x/y for every player and ball
- Stable player/team IDs and substitution handling
- Possession phases, team direction and coordinate normalization
- Tracking quality / sampling frequency / missing-frame metadata
- Video review to code runs, decoy movements and missed lanes

OUTPUTS TO GENERATE ONCE DATA IS AVAILABLE

1. **Shot maps & xG**
2. **Pass arrows & network**
3. **Pressure / PPDA zones**
4. **Recovery + turnover maps**
5. **Average positions / shape**
6. **Space occupation & line gaps**

This report is a sourced match analysis and design blueprint. It is not a substitute for a provider event feed.

10 | Sources and methodology

PUBLIC MATCH SOURCES

[1] Opta Analyst - match report and event narrative

https://theanalyst.com/articles/barcelona-vs-real-madrid-el-clasico-live-stats-10-2026

Match timeline, two Mbappe goals, transition narrative, Yamal shot/xG details and goal sequence graphic.

[2] FC Barcelona - official match report

https://www.fcbarcelona.com/en/news/4598638/fc-barcelona-1-2-real-madrid-heartbreaking-defeat

Barcelona account of the first goal, second-half possession, Pedri-Raphinha equaliser and the late counter.

[3] Reuters - Mourinho tactical response

https://www.reuters.com/sports/soccer/mourinho-gives-real-madrid-answers-barcelona-test-return-clasico-2026-10-2

Madrid playing through pressure, tactical organization and Valverde identifying space after turnovers.

[4] FotMob - match centre

https://www.fotmob.com/matches/real-madrid-vs-barcelona/2grk20

xG 1.19 vs 1.95, possession, shots, box touches, keeper saves and goal timeline.

[5] FBref - match report

https://fbref.com/en/matches/3602861a/El-Clasico-Barcelona-Real-Madrid-October-25-2026-La-Liga

Team stats including shots, possession, interceptions, fouls and other match-level measures.

[6] StatMuse - match statistics

https://www.statmuse.com/fc/match/10-25-2026-fcb-vs-rma-113539

Cross-check for recoveries, clearances, saves, xG, touches in the box and other aggregated metrics.

[7] User-supplied: El_Clasico_2026_Post_Match_Data_Analysis.pdf

Uploaded in this conversation

Six-page secondary analysis; used as input, with discrepancies labelled rather than silently reconciled.

[8] User-supplied: El_Clasico_Analytics_Report_2024_2026.pdf

Uploaded in this conversation

Twenty-page image-based dashboard report; consulted for visual context. Its schematic pitch drawings are not treated as tracking data.

[9] Futbal - Barcelona 1-2 Real Madrid match stats

https://futbal.app/fixtures/1165

Cross-check for shot outcomes, pass accuracy, tackles, defensive stats and big chances.

Method: consistent score / possession / shot figures were prioritized across public match pages. Small provider differences in xG and goal-minute notation are noted. Qualitative tactical claims are tied to published match reports. Derived calculations (xG per shot and conversion) are arithmetic from the stated totals.

Appendix A | Original generated dashboard concept

DESIGN REFERENCE ONLY - This generated infographic includes illustrative pitch dots, heat blobs, passing links and some in-image metrics that may be inaccurate. It is retained because it was requested as a visual input; do not cite its maps or embedded values as verified match evidence.



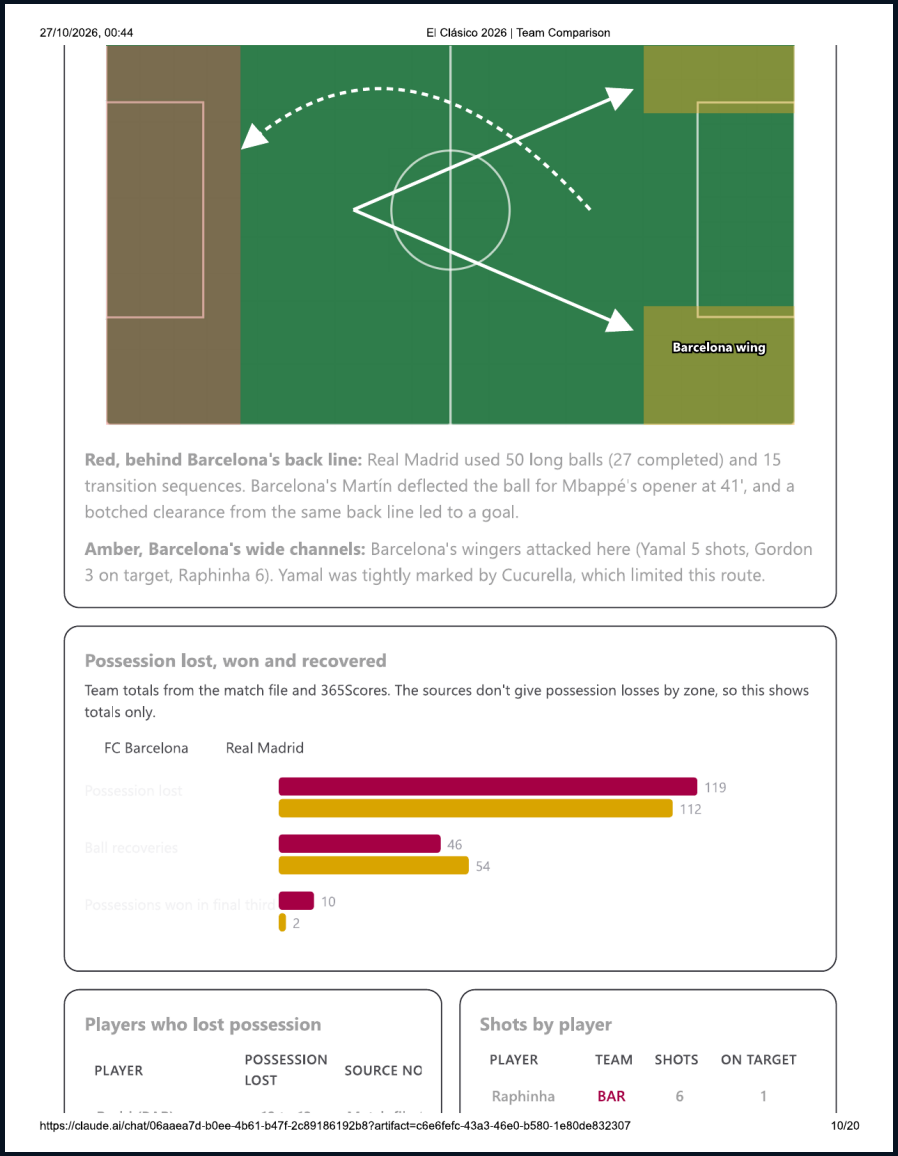
Appendix B | Revised generated dashboard concept

SCHEMATIC / NOT EVENT COORDINATES - This version visibly labels tactical map panels as schematic. It is a proposed layout for separate Barcelona and Madrid layers; the actual map positions still need a valid event feed.



Appendix C | Visual extract from supplied 2024-2026 report

This extract is included for continuity with the earlier supplied dashboard. Its arrows and zone shading are schematic and are not certified player-tracking coordinates. The main report above uses the same tactical idea only when supported by published match narratives.



HOW THIS IMAGE IS USED IN THE NEW REPORT

Kept: the concept of space behind the defensive line, width in the wide channels, and the need to separate ball-lost and ball-recovered information.

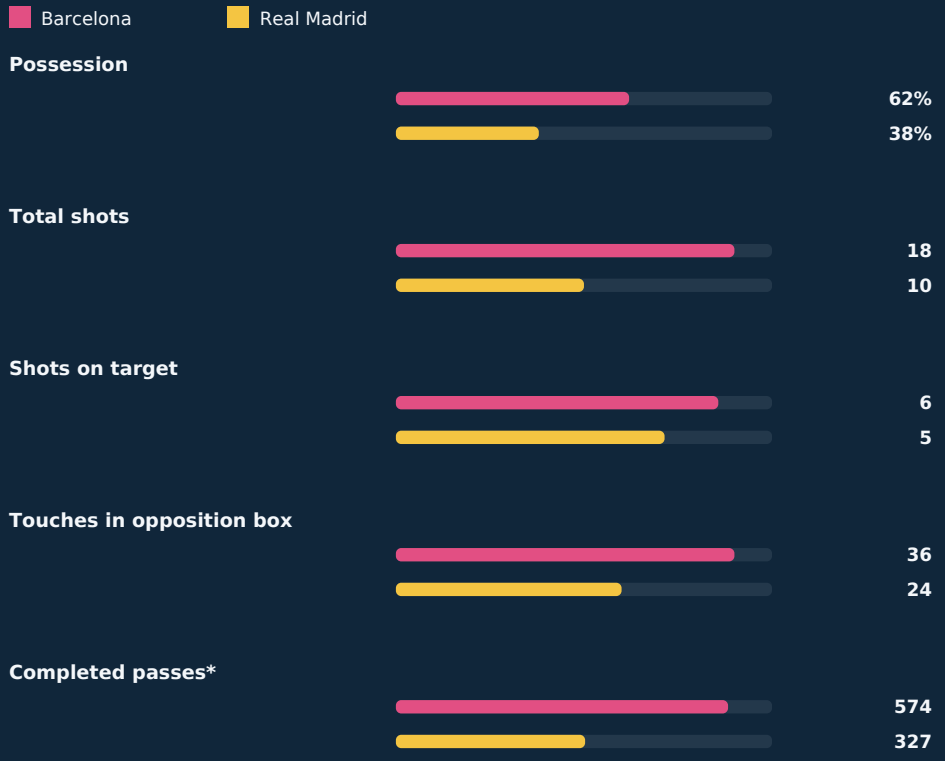
Not accepted as measured facts: the route arrows, shaded zones and any claim about exact coordinates. The page itself labels the arrows as schematic and says zone-level turnover data is not provided.

Cross-check: the space-behind-the-line interpretation is also described in the Opta Analyst and Reuters match reports. It remains a qualitative finding until event/tracking data is supplied. [1][3]

Source file: El_Clasico_Analytics_Report_2024_2026.pdf, page 10 of the supplied 20-page document.

Appendix D | Match output graphs - volume vs threat

VOLUME: BARCELONA LED



*Pass data uses the StatMuse match-centre definition: 574/645 completed for Barcelona and 327/385 for Madrid. Other providers display different totals; do not merge definitions. [6]

THREAT: MADRID GENERATED MORE HIGH-VALUE CHANCES



Interpretation: Barcelona won the possession/attempt-volume contest; Madrid led in xG, big chances, conversion and final score. This explains the outcome more directly than possession alone. xG is a model estimate, not a count of goals. [1][4][6]

Appendix E | Shot profile, xG and conversion

SHOT OUTCOMES (COUNTS)



CHANCE QUALITY AND FINISHING



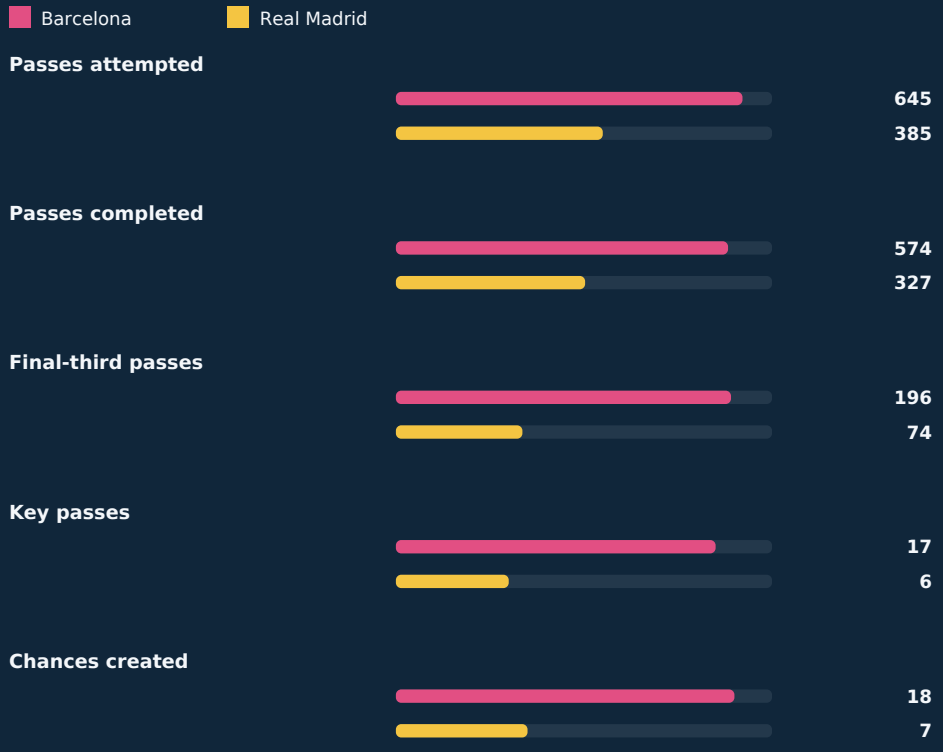
WHAT THE SHOT DATA DOES - AND DOES NOT - SHOW

Shot-outcome totals: Barcelona 6 on target + 6 off target + 6 blocked = 18 shots; Madrid 5 + 3 + 2 = 10. The xG-per-shot ratio is 0.195 for Madrid and 0.066 for Barcelona (about 2.95x on this model). Published Opta reporting also notes that Yamal had five attempts worth 0.51 xG without scoring. [1][4][6]

Not supported by aggregate totals alone: precise shot coordinates, exact distance/angle for every attempt, whether a shot was under pressure, or where each block occurred. A verified shot-event export is needed to build a true event-dot map.

Appendix F | Passing, progression and chance creation

PASSING OUTPUT



Source-specific numbers from StatMuse; completed passes are 89% of attempts for Barcelona and 85% for Madrid (calculated from 574/645 and 327/385). [6]

WHAT PASSING SAYS ABOUT SPACE



*StatMuse lists 21 vs 50 in its “Long Ball Passes” field; provider counting definitions may differ. Crosses/through-ball values are event counts, not passing networks. [6]

Space interpretation: Barcelona’s 196 final-third passes and higher xA align with their territory/possession advantage. Madrid’s 50 long-ball passes and the two reported transition goals/major breaks support a more direct threat. A real pass-line network requires every pass start and end coordinate; totals alone cannot show the actual lanes.

Appendix G | Recoveries, defending and goalkeeper contribution

DEFENSIVE / BALL-WINNING TOTALS



Match-centre totals from StatMuse/FBref. These describe counts, not defensive quality adjusted for time without the ball. [5][6]

GOALKEEPER + INTERPRETATION



Why the defence metrics need context: Madrid defended for longer spells because they had 38% possession. Higher clearances and interceptions partly describe the workload of a team defending more often; they are not proof, in isolation, that Madrid's defence was "better". Five Lunin saves were also important in preserving the lead and the 1-1 score. [4][6]

Data boundary: these are match totals. They do not identify the exact pitch zone of each recovery or interception, pressure intensity, or whether each action initiated a counterattack.

Appendix H | Goal timeline and the winning sequence

GOAL TIMELINE

41' — **Mbappé 0-1**

Diomandé cross; Martín clearance deflects in

61' — **Raphinha 1-1**

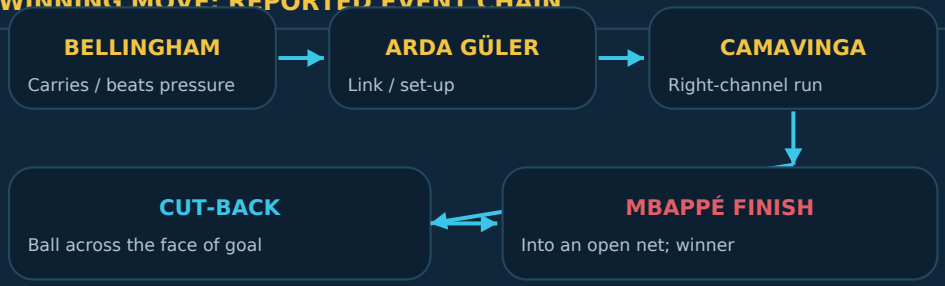
Pedri pass into right side of the area

87' / 88' — **Mbappé 1-2**

Bellingham progression; Camavinga cut-back

Minute note: Opta/FotMob list the winner at 87 minutes; some match centres show 88 minutes due to time notation/provider display. [1][2][4]

WINNING MOVE: REPORTED EVENT CHAIN



The sequence is based on the match reporting from Real Madrid and Opta Analyst; node placement is a flow diagram, not player coordinates or measured distance. [1][3]

TACTICAL MECHANISM

1. Progression: Bellingham advanced the transition and committed Barcelona's recovery defenders.

2. Width and timing: Camavinga, introduced in the 80th minute, attacked the right channel as the move developed.

3. Final action: the cut-back reached Mbappé close to goal, producing a much higher-probability finish than an outside-box attempt.

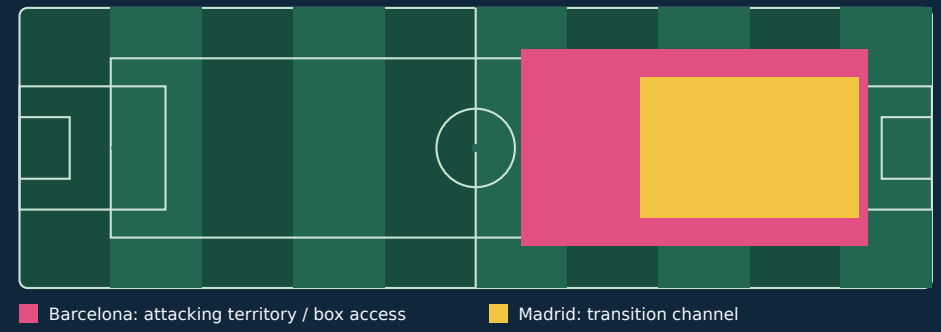
This explains the decisive attack qualitatively. Exact distances, defender gaps and player-speed measures require tracking coordinates.

Appendix I | Space used, space conceded and space missed

TERRITORY VS HIGH-VALUE THREAT



TACTICAL SPACE MAP - QUALITATIVE ONLY



TEAM-BY-TEAM INTERPRETATION

Barcelona - space used: 62% possession, 36 opposition-box touches and 18 attempts show greater territory and volume. Pedri found Raphinha on the right side of the area for the equaliser. Space conceded: reports describe Madrid finding space behind Barcelona's defensive line after turnovers. Space missed: no coordinate-level dataset can prove which open lanes were ignored.

Real Madrid - space used: the decisive late transition moved from Bellingham through the right-channel Camavinga run to Mbappé's close-range finish. Space conceded: Barcelona still generated 18 shots and 36 box touches, so Madrid did not eliminate all attacking space. Space missed: Madrid also failed to convert earlier counterattacking chances; the Opta report notes a promising first-half counter was not completed.

"Space missed" is an analyst concept, not a standard match statistic. Quantifying it requires synchronized player-tracking data plus video/event review.

Sourced match-report analysis. Schematic diagrams are explicitly labelled; no tracking dataset was supplied.

Appendix J | Tactical map data checklist and source rules

WHAT CAN BE CLAIMED FROM CURRENT MATCH REPORTING?

MAP / OUTPUT	AVAILABLE EVIDENCE	STATUS IN THIS REPORT	DATA NEEDED FOR TRUE MAP
Shot locations + xG	Team shots, xG, outcomes; Yamal 5 shots / 0.51 xG in Opta report.	Aggregates verified; full coordinate plot not reproduced.	Shot events with x/y, outcome and xG.
Passing lines / network	Pass totals, final-third passes, key passes, xA; goal-pass narratives.	Counts are source-specific; connections not reconstructed.	Passer/receiver IDs and start/end x/y.
Pressing heat map / PPDA	Match reports describe pressure and Madrid playing through it.	Qualitative only; no pressure event coordinates.	Pressure events, opponent passes and defensive-action events.
Recoveries / losses	46 vs 54 recoveries; aggregate defensive totals.	Team totals only; no zone dots or player-level heat map.	Ball-recovery and possession-loss event x/y + timestamps.
Space used / conceded	Box touches, territory indicators and narrated goal sequences.	Interpretive space diagram only.	Tracking positions for all players/ball or event coordinates.
Average positions / formation	FotMob lists both starting structures as 4-2-3-1; other sources vary.	Lineup labels are not average player coordinates.	Player tracking or event-based average positions, phase-split.

Method rule: published match facts and derived arithmetic are stated directly; narrative interpretations are attributed to Opta/club reports; schematic diagrams are labelled; unverified coordinate-dependent claims are excluded. [1][2][4][6]

OPEN OPTA MATCH REPORT